Identifying State Treasurers in the Pre-1790 and Post-1790 Data

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1 Introduction

This report examines where the 1790 state treasurers appear in the pre- and post-1790 bond records, aiming to understand whether the state treasurers benefited from the refunding. To do this, the treasurers were searched and then graphed against other individuals within the liquidated debt and loan office certificates, and 6% and 3% stocks.

2 Summary

1. **A majority of the treasurers did not own any certificates or stock**. Out of the 13 identified state treasurers, only five owned loan office certificates, one owned liquidated debt certificates, and six owned post-1790 stock.
2. **Pre-1790 holdings in loan-office certificates were high**. While not exceedingly high, matched state treasurers were all in the upper quartile. The one liquidated debt certificate owned was for 30 cents, a negligible amount.
3. **Post-1790 holdings in 6% stock were low**. Most treasurers lost or barely gained face value, aside from John Haywood. Overall, face value was lost across all the state treasurers.
4. **Gerard Bancker (NY state treasurer) held the most 3% stock out of all individuals**. Otherwise, the treasurers held fairly little 3% stock.

3 Limitations

1. Unidentified South Carolina state treasurers could impact the results.
2. Like much analysis done with this data, individuals with identical names and home states are considered identical people.

4 Analysis

4.1 Identifying the State Treasurers

Most state treasurers could be easily identified via The Political Graveyard. By searching "[state] state treasurers" in their custom Google search portal, lists of existing state treasurers could be accessed, where it was just a manner of identifying which served during 1790. Others not found on The Political Graveyard were found on Wikipedia records. The only state for which a state treasurer could not be found was South Carolina, which also maintained two divisions with two different treasurers.

4.2 Matching the State Treasurers

Within the documents, the state treasurers' names and states were compared against the records to return the certificates for each treasurer:

1. Loan office certificates were totalled by person through under the criterion of same `raw_name` and `state`.

2. Pre-1790: Check for treasurer matches in both `raw_name` and `state`.

3. Post-1790: Check for treasurer matches in both `Group Name` and `Group State`.

4.3 Pre-1790 Results

Only one treasurer held any liquidated debt certificates, being James Mott from New Jersey. Seeing as he only held 30 cents of debt, and no other treasurer held any certificates, the rest of the pre-1790 analysis will focus on loan office certificates.

The treasurers with loan office certificates were the following: James Mott (NJ), Jedediah Huntington (CT), Christian Febiger (PA), William Gardner (NH), and William Richardson (MD).

Name	Face Value ($)	Face Value (%ile)	Specie Value (Spanish $)	Specie Value (%ile)
William Gardner	42,600.00	99.13	24,671.11	99.79
Jedediah Huntington	25,400.00	98.40	12,860.93	99.46
James Mott	5,800.00	91.14	277.17	75.98
Christian Febiger	5,000.00	89.27	125.00	61.29
William Richardson	3,000.00	83.28	237.63	73.64

Table 1: Treasurer Loan Office Certificate Face and Specie Values and Percentiles

William Gardner and Jedediah Huntginton held the most debt, being in the 98th and 99th percentile in both face and specie value. The other three treasurers held certificates with percentiles of 91.14, 89.27, and 83.28. However, when looking at the specie value, these percentiles drop to 75.98, 61.29, and 73.64.

These totals can be graphed against the total face and specie values held by other certificate owners to see how the treasurers compare.

Although the treasurers did own a higher face value than the median loan office certificate owner did, they didn't own a significantly high amount, as many individuals held hundreds of thousands in loan office certificates, the highest being $680,000 owned by John Cox.

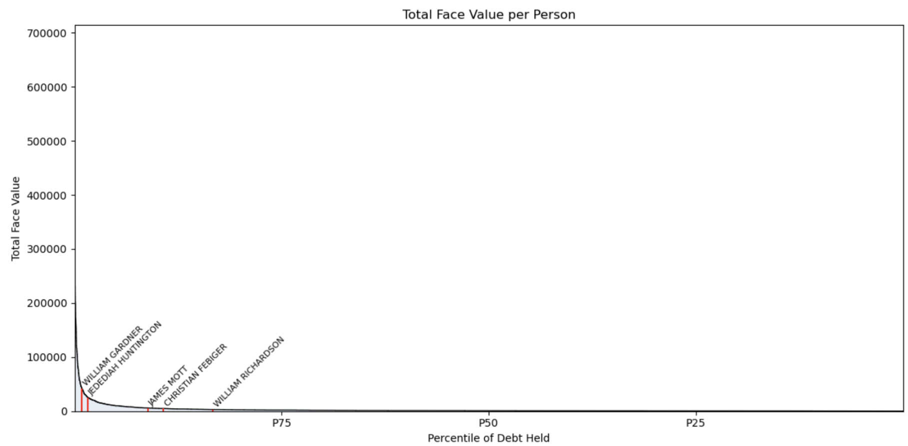

Figure 1: Total Face Value per Person

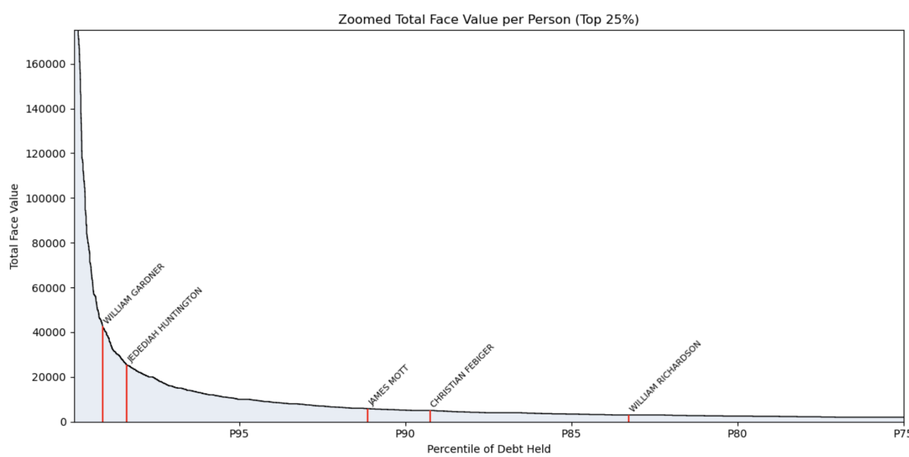

Figure 2: Total Face Value per Person (Top 25%)

The same applies for specie value, with the most owned by an individual being about 200,000 Spanish dollars, much higher than William Gardner's 24,671. There were considerable decreases in specie value across all individuals, however, leading to William Gardner and Jedediah Huntington advancing in placement when measuring value.

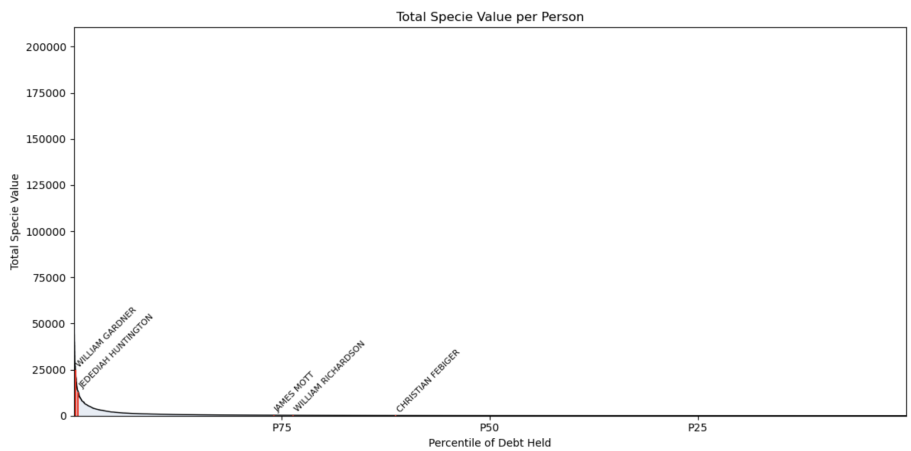

Figure 3: Total Specie Value per Person

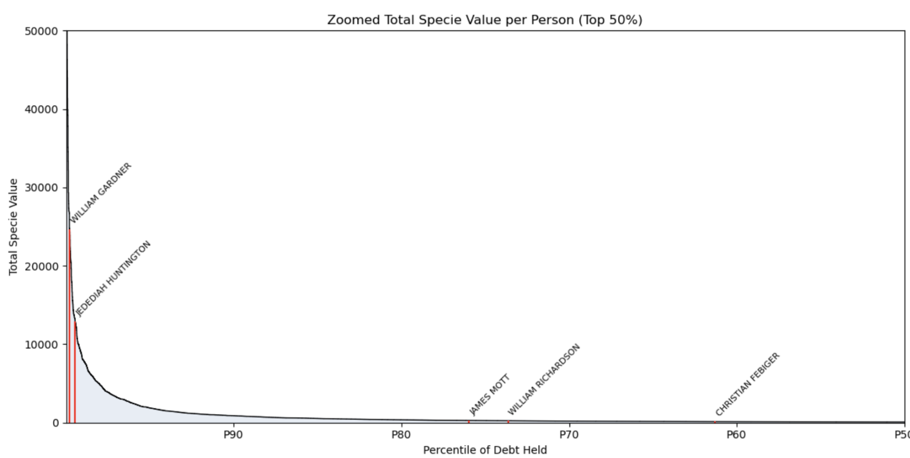

Figure 4: Total Specie Value per Person (Top 50%)

4.4 Post-1790 Results

The post-1790 data was similarly divided into two categories, being the total amount of 3% stocks and 6% stocks (both regular and deferred) that each person held.

More state treasurers appeared in the post-1790 data as opposed to the pre-1790 data, with a total of six names as opposed to five: Gerard Bancker (NY), Jedediah Huntington (NH), John Haywood (NC), John Meals (GA), William Gardner (NH), and William Richardson (MD).

Name	6p Stock ($)	6p Stock (%ile)	3p Stock ($)	3p Stock (%ile)
John Haywood	25,596.40	98.29	15,780.90	97.72
William Gardner	1,099.50	68.77	266.56	52.30
William Richardson	394.95	48.77	257.82	51.85
John Meals	153.63	30.38	28.29	11.69
Jedediah Huntington	3.94	0.57	2.58	0.45
Gerard Bancker	0.00	0.00	689,658.99	100.00

Table 2: Treasurer 6p and 3p Stock Holdings and Percentiles

Out of the treasurers, John Haywood held the most in 6% stocks, owning $25,596 at the 98th percentile. William Gardner was the only other treasurer above the median, with the remaining four owning a few hundred dollars or even nothing at all.

The highest amount of 6% stock was held by The State of South Carolina, which owned $1.2 million of debt. The highest amount of 6% stock held by an individual belonged to Benjamin Harwood, who owned around $645,000, the second highest holding. Compared to the total amount of 6% stock owned by these two and the leading crowd, the treasurers again owned significantly little.

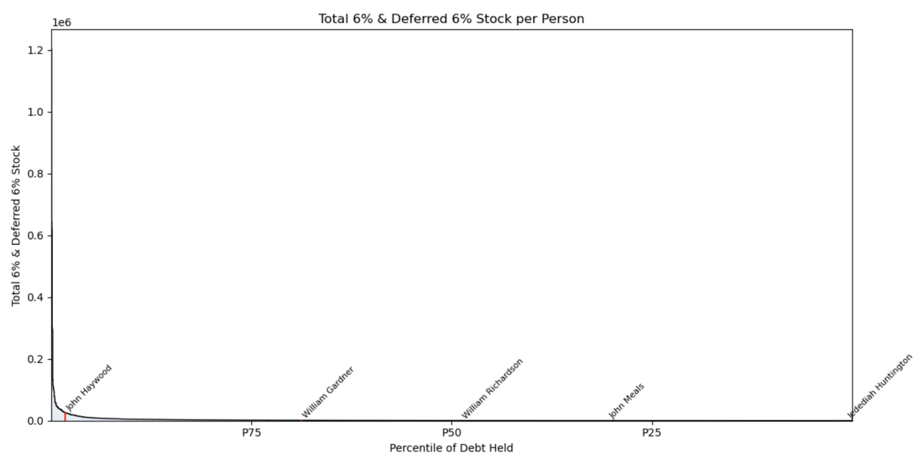

Figure 5: Total 6% and 6% Deferred Stock per Person

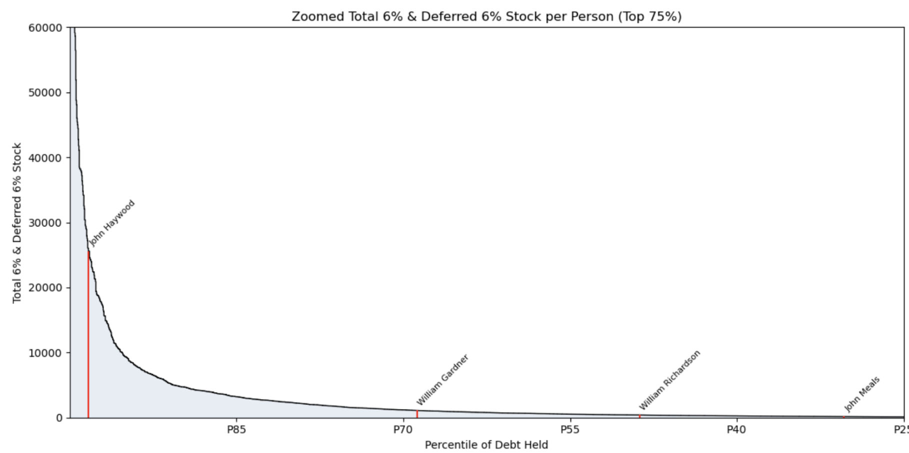

Figure 6: Total 6% and 6% Deferred Stock per Person (Top 75%)

Things take a turn however, when looking at 3% stock. Gerard Bancker owned the most out of all stock owners, holding an impressive $689,658.99 in 3% stock. John Haywood trails in the 97th percentile, with a much smaller $15,780.90.

The second highest amount of 3% stock is held by Benjamin Harwood again, owning around $300,000 of 3% stock, less than half of that owned by Gerard Bancker.

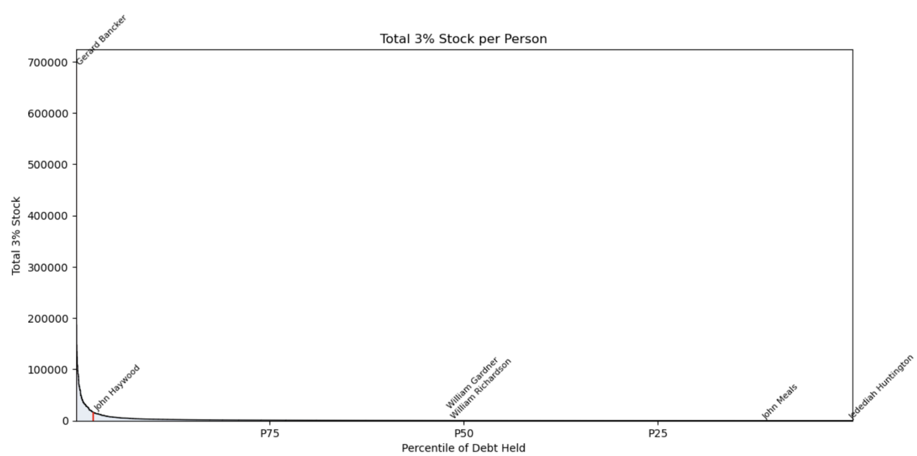

Figure 7: Total 3% Stock per Person

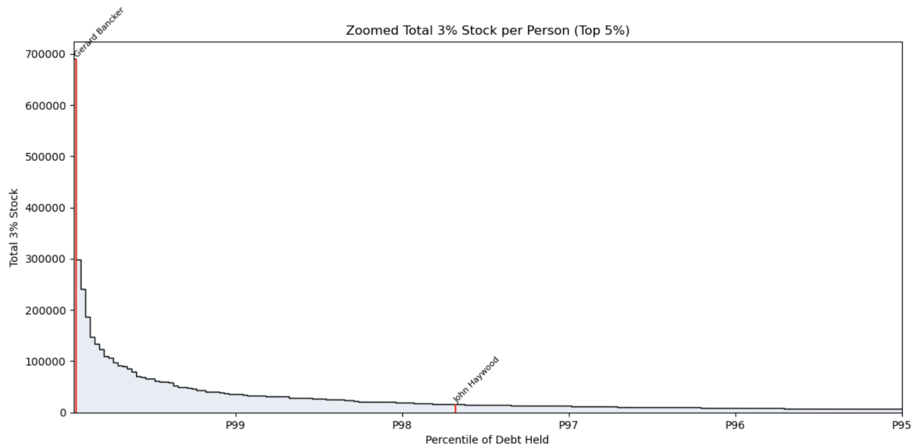

Figure 8: Total 3% Stock per Person (Top 5%)

William Gardner and William Richardson are situated right around the 50th percentile mark, each owning a little more than $250 in 3% stock.

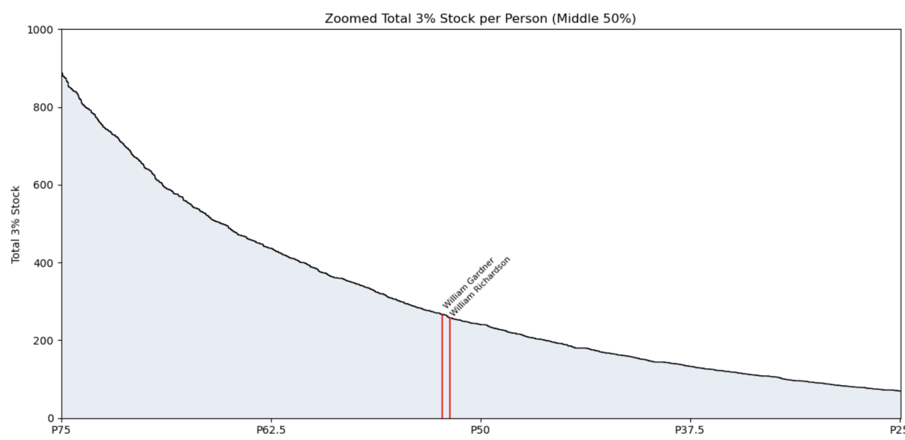

Figure 9: Total 3% Stock per Person (Middle 50%)

4.5 Did the State Treasurers Benefit?

Because we know that loan office certificates could be traded at par for 6% stocks, we can determine how much in loan office certificates the post-1790 matched treasurers owned. This allows us to compare the initial holdings of state treasurers to their holdings in 1790 when the certificates were exchanged.

Across the pre- and post-1790 data, only Jedediah Huntington, William Gardner, and William Richardson appear in both. All see a decrease in face value, with the total owned among the three changing from $71,000 to $1,498.39, a significant decrease.

Name	Face Value ($)	6p Stock ($)
William Gardner	42,600.00	1,099.50
Jedediah Huntington	25,400.00	3.94
William Richardson	3,000.00	394.95

Table 3: Treasurer Loan Office Certificate Face Value vs 6p Stock

The state treasurers which appear only in the pre-1790 data lost $10,800 in face value, and the treasurers which appear only in the post-1790 data gained $25,750.03, almost entirely by John Haywood.

Across all the state treasurers, there was a decrease in face value from $81,800 to $27,248.42, suggesting that the state treasurers as a whole didn't benefit off of 6% stocks.

It is plausible that the state treasurers didn't own any debt themselves, rather owning them on behalf of the state. This could explain why Gerard Bancker owned such a high amount of 3% stock, while not owning any 6% stock. The State of New York doesn't appear in the Post-1790 records, which could support this explanation, however, only two out of the 13 states appear, so it isn't solid proof.